RESERVE BANK OF INDIA

Department of Regulation

Title: Master Direction on Operational Resilience and Business Continuity, 2026

Reference number: RBI/2026-27/42 DOR.ORG.REC/03/2026

Date: March 10, 2026

1. Applicability and Scope

1.1 These Directions shall apply to all Regulated Entities, and each entity shall identify its critical operations and map the people, processes, technology, and third parties supporting each critical operation within 6 months of issuance of these Directions.

1.2 Regulated Entities shall set impact tolerances for each critical operation expressed as maximum tolerable disruption, and the Board of Directors shall approve the tolerances at least once every twelve months.

2. Continuity Requirements

2.1 Regulated Entities shall define a Recovery Time Objective not exceeding 4 hours and a Recovery Point Objective not exceeding 2 hours for each critical operation, and recovery capability shall be demonstrated through testing at least once every six months.

2.2 Regulated Entities shall maintain alternate processing sites with independent power and connectivity capable of assuming critical operations within the approved Recovery Time Objective, and switchover drills shall be conducted within every twelve months.

2.3 Regulated Entities shall assess the resilience of material third-party service providers at least once every twelve months, and contracts shall include the right to audit and a termination clause exercisable within 90 days for persistent resilience failures.

2.4 Regulated Entities shall maintain a business continuity plan documenting communication protocols, and the plan shall be activated for any disruption expected to exceed 2 hours with notification to the Reserve Bank within 24 hours of activation.

2.5 Regulated Entities shall preserve backup copies of critical data in at least two geographically separate locations, and restoration from backup shall be tested for at least one critical operation within every three months on a rotational basis.

3. Governance and Review

3.1 The Risk Management Committee shall review resilience testing outcomes at least once every six months, and the Operations function shall report breaches of impact tolerance with remediation timelines at each review.

3.2 Regulated Entities shall conduct a full-scope resilience self-assessment at least once every twelve months, and deficiencies rated high shall be remediated within 90 days with closure evidence retained for supervisory inspection.